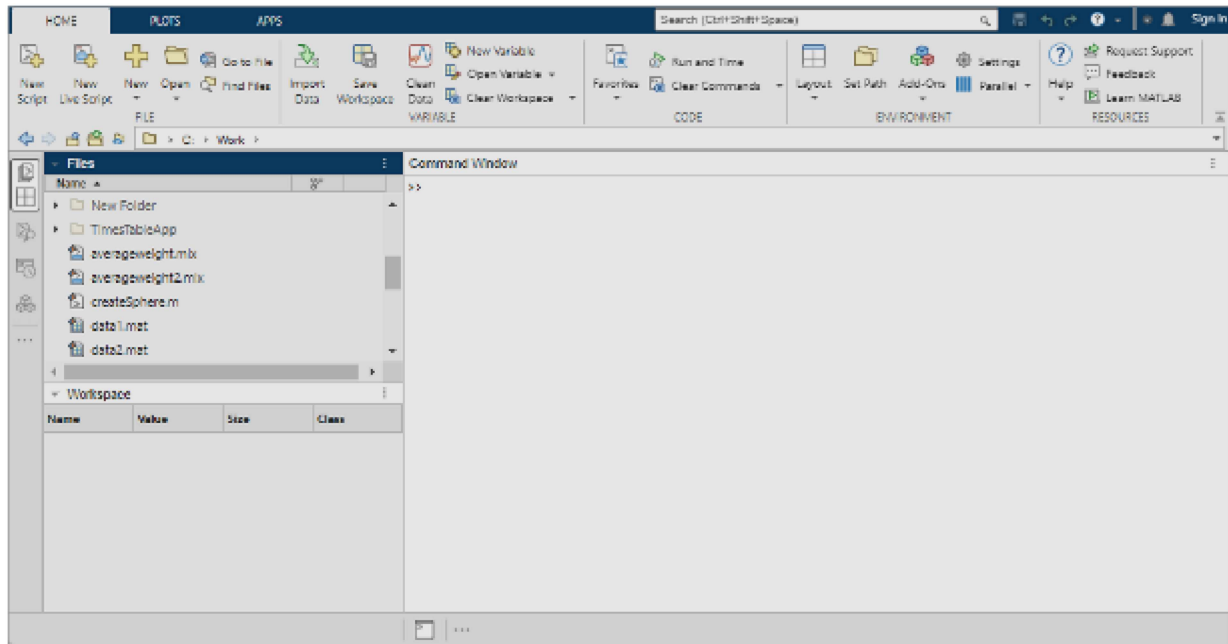


Desktop Basics

When you start MATLAB®, the desktop appears in its default layout.



The desktop includes these areas:

- Files panel — Access your files.
- Workspace panel — Explore data that you create or import from files.
- Command Window — Enter commands at the command line, indicated by the prompt (>>).
- Sidebars — Access tools docked in the desktop and additional panels.

As you work in MATLAB, you issue commands that create variables and call functions. For example, create a variable named `a` by typing this statement at the command line:

```
a = 1
```

MATLAB adds variable `a` to the workspace and displays the result in the Command Window.

```
a =
```

```
1
```

Create a few more variables.

```
b = 2
```

```
b =
```

```
2
```

```
c = a + b
```

```
c =
```

```
3
```

```
d = cos(a)
```

```
d =
```

```
0.5403
```

When you do not specify an output variable, MATLAB uses the variable `ans`, short for *answer*, to store the results of your calculation.

```
sin(a)
```

```
ans =
```

```
0.8415
```

If you end a statement with a semicolon, MATLAB performs the computation, but suppresses the display of output in the Command Window.

```
e = a*b;
```

You can recall previous commands by pressing the up- and down-arrow keys, $\uparrow$ and $\downarrow$. Press the arrow keys either at an empty command line or after you type the first few characters of a command. For example, to recall the command `b = 2`, type `b`, and then press the up-arrow key.

Get Started with MATLAB



NEXT >